

FGFR: 5 molecules stopped early, all small molecules

6 stopped trials, but 5 molecules — all small molecules: Regorafenib, Fgfr Inhibitor Debio 1347, Infigratinib, Nintedanib and 1 more. Against 5.0% for all oncology trials with a resolved drug target and 4.3% across all oncology Phase 2,3 trials in the same window. Rates count trials that stopped early for efficacy, safety or benefit–risk reasons; trials that completed and missed their endpoints are not counted.

3.6%

6 of 167 closed trials (95% CI 1.7%–7.6%)

3 / 0 / 1

efficacy / safety / both (adds to 6)

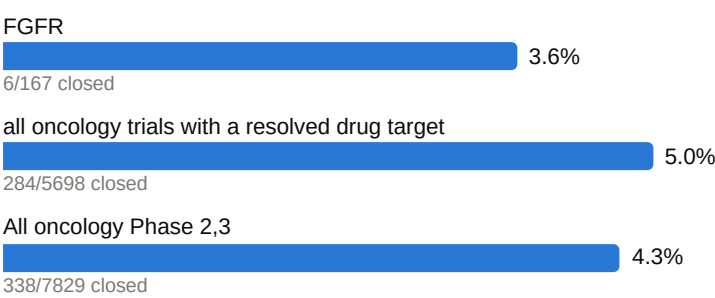
47.6%

of 351 trials have closed · 184 still open or unresolved

1.7%

stopped for a biological reason within 3 years of starting (95% CI 0.6%–4.5%; 159 still at risk; 1.5% area-wide)

How this compares



What is in this class: 212 distinct experimental drugs across 351 trials (small molecule 341, antibody 126, unknown 46, adc 7). Most tested: REGORAFENIB (109), SURUFATINIB (67), PEMIGATINIB (36), PAZOPANIB (26), NIVOLUMAB (23). A class groups drugs by what they act on; check that the grouping is one you would make before reading the rate as a property of the mechanism.

How much does this rest on one decision? The 6 stops came from 6 sponsor-asset programmes across 6 sponsors; the largest (University of Texas Southwestern Medical Center) contributed 1; removing that programme's trials from both sides leaves 3.0%. Screened alongside 85 other segments in this area, it does not survive a 10% false-discovery correction (q=1, Benjamini-Yekutieli). A further 19 closed trials here were terminated with no cause recorded in the registry; if every one of them were biological the rate would be 15.0%. Read it as a screen worth checking against the underlying trials.

Bars show the share of closed trials stopped for biological reasons. Confidence intervals overlap where sample sizes are small — read the counts, not just the bars.

By start cohort

Trials started	Stops	Closed	Rate	95% CI
2015–2017	1	75	1.3%	0.2%–7.2%
2018–2020	3	53	5.7%	1.9%–15.4%
2021–2024	2	39	5.1%	1.4%–16.9%

Where the stops sit

Efficacy / futility: 3, Benefit–risk: 2, Efficacy and safety: 1. Sponsors with most stops: Great Novel Therapeutics Biotech & Medicals Corporation (1), Incyte (1), UNICANCER (1), University of Texas Southwestern Medical Center (1), Debiopharm International SA (1), National Institute of Dental and Craniofacial Research (NIDCR) (1).

The stopped trials

Trial	Ph	Sponsor	Experimental drugs	Stopped	Type	Registry stop reason
NCT05770882	2	Great Novel Therapeutics Biotech & Medicals Corporation	TUCIDINOSTAT, REGORAFENIB	2025-01	Benefit–risk	The overall profile does not support development for Hepatocellular Carcinoma
NCT05267106	2	Incyte INCY	PEMIGATINIB	2024-12	Efficacy	Recruitment ceased after a pre-planned futility interim analysis indicated a low probability to confer a clinically meaningful improvement in objective response when compared to currently available therapies. There were no safety related concerns.
NCT03722108	2	UNICANCER	REGORAFENIB, IRINOTECAN	2022-05	Benefit–risk	Unfavorable benefit-risk balance in the experimental arm following the IDMC for intermediate efficacy and safety analysis

Trial	Ph	Sponsor	Experimental drugs	Stopped	Type	Registry stop reason
NCT02902484	2	University of Texas Southwestern Medical Center	NINTEDANIB	2021-10	Efficacy	The study was terminated due to futility and lack of future funding
NCT03834220	2	Debiopharm International SA	FGFR INHIBITOR DEBIO 1347	2020-12	Efficacy	Due to lower antitumor activity than expected
NCT03510455	2	National Institute of Dental and Craniofacial Research (NIDCR)	INFIGRATINIB	2020-02	Efficacy + safety	Study was stopped early due to a greater than expected incidence of ocular AEs and analysis of the data from the first 4 subjects indicating that the likelihood of permanent remission with this therapy was low.

Method

Denominator: ClinicalTrials.gov interventional Phase 2,3 oncology trials started 2015–2024 that have closed (completed or terminated). Numerator: terminated trials whose registry stop reason is classified as biological (efficacy, safety or benefit–risk) by Classification V2 — held-out precision 95.5%, recall 95.3% (n=600). Drugs are linked to ChEMBL and the NCI Thesaurus; 76% of industry oncology trials in this window carry a resolved drug target, and a trial without one cannot enter a mechanism class. Intervals are Wilson 95%.

Limits

Not a failure rate: trials that completed with negative results are not counted, and programs discontinued after a completed trial do not appear. Stop reasons are sponsor-reported. This is a closed-trial proportion, not a time-to-event analysis: only 47.6% of trials in this segment have closed, and a trial that stops early enters the denominator sooner than one that runs to completion, which can inflate the rate in immature segments. Recent cohorts have fewer closed trials, so their rates are less stable. Research signals, not clinical or investment advice.

Any mechanism, sponsor or indication, updated weekly. The dataset behind this brief covers every stopped oncology trial with an efficacy or safety signal plus the full denominator universe. Free sample and licensing: clinicaltrialfailures.com/pricing

Sources: ClinicalTrials.gov (NLM); ChEMBL (EMBL-EBI, CC BY-SA 3.0); NCI Thesaurus (NCI); RxNorm/RxClass (NLM); SEC EDGAR. Classification, linkage and rates by Clinical Trial Failures. Rebuilt weekly; this brief covers trials started 2015–2024.